

Agent File Layout & Repository Scaffolding Standard

1. Document Format Taxonomy

Agents operate with strict performance bounds across specific file formats:

- **Markdown (.md)**: Primary medium for human-readable semantic notes, system prompts, specifications, and living wikis.
- **JSON Lines (.jsonl)**: Purpose-built for streaming records, pre-tokenized chunks, training trajectories, and fast line-by-line machine retrieval.
- **PDF (.pdf)**: Immutable cold-storage backups, research papers, and static vendor manuals.
- **Skill Definitions (SKILL.md)**: Procedural instruction files containing YAML frontmatter and strict agent execution directives.

2. Universal Repository Triad

Every repository root maintains three core baseline files:

1. **README.md** — Human identity, setup instructions, and W5+H scope.
2. **manifest.jsonl** — Machine-readable inventory of all files, hashes, and retrieval tags.
3. **MAP.md** (or **llm_wiki.md**) — Visual navigation map and conceptual ontology.

3. High-Speed Local Search Architecture

To enable low-latency **grep** and AST scanning without network bottlenecks:

- Workspaces are mirrored or cloned to local storage.
- Agents execute localized **grep -rn "term" ./** and AST mappers over **.md** and **.jsonl** files directly.